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Lien Release

When a car loan is paid off, the lender (lienholder) no longer has a legal interest in the vehicle and will relinquish that interest by issuing a lien release. The lien release process can vary by state.

Arizona Titles and Liens

The first lien is the primary lien and is the only lien recognized when performing a repossession title service. However, lien releases may be accepted in any order.



A second (or third) lien's release may allow the removal of the second (or third) lien, while the primary lien remains on the record.

- ▶ **Electronic Lien Release**
- ▶ **Paper Lien Release**
- ▶ **Signature Requirements for Removing a Lien**
- ▶ **Lien Release Exceptions**
- ▶ **When a Lien Clearance is Not Required**
- ▶ **Lien-Free Title of Record**

Out-of-State Titles and Liens

To remove a lien from an out-of-state title, Arizona will follow that state's process and requirements. A title issued from out-of-state may be used to remove an Arizona titled lien if all the following conditions are met:

- Arizona had the previous title
- The lien (previously record in Arizona) does not appear on the foreign jurisdiction title
- The out-of-state title requirements for a lien to be released will be in conjunction with that state's requirements
- The out-of-state title was issued (at least) one year prior to the date of application



The customer originated a title in Arizona with a lienholder and moved to another state with the title.

The customer returned to Arizona (less than a year) with no lienholder showing on the title.

The customer must show some type of lien satisfaction.

▶ **Release a Lien During Title Only or Title and Registration Service**

▶ **Remove a Lien using Manage Liens and Brands Service**

Policies

[8.3.2 Legal Status Multiple Owners Legal Status Change](#)

[8.3.4 Power of Attorney](#)

[8.4.1 Lien Filing](#)

[8.4.2 Lien Clearance Requirements](#)

[8.4.3 Operation of Law Liens](#)

[8.4.4 Restitution Liens](#)

Forms

[#48-9901 Lien Release](#)

[#96-0330 Lienholder Complaint Report](#)

[#40-5009 Restitution Lien Hearing Request](#)

Charts

[Identification Requirements for T&R Transactions](#)

[Signature Requirements for T&R Transactions](#)

HELPFUL LINKS

» [MVD / DMV Public Website](#) »

» [Customer Portal](#) »

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